

SOUTH KOREA

Key Country Details: South Korea

Detail	Information
Full Name	Republic of Korea
Short Form	South Korea
Capital	Seoul
Region (UN)	Asia – Eastern Asia
Government Type	Unitary presidential constitutional republic
Head of State	President Yoon Suk-yeol
Head of Government	Prime Minister Han Duck-soo
Currency	South Korean Won (KRW)
UN Member Since	1991
MUN Standing	Active contributor in peacekeeping, development, disarmament, and democracy.

Book Recommendations on South Korean Foreign Policy & UN Engagement

1. **"South Korea at the Crossroads"** – Scott A. Snyder
<https://www.amazon.com/South-Korea-Crossroads-Autonomy-Relations/dp/0231185480>
2. **"South Korea's Grand Strategy: Making Its Own Destiny"** – Kyle Ferrier
<https://www.amazon.com/South-Koreas-Grand-Strategy-Destiny/dp/0815739509>
3. **"The Two Koreas: A Contemporary History"** – Don Oberdorfer & Robert Carlin
<https://www.amazon.com/Two-Koreas-Contemporary-History/dp/0465031234>
4. **"Korea: A New History of South and North"** – Victor Cha & Ramon Pacheco Pardo

<https://yalebooks.yale.edu/book/9780300278705/korea/>

5. **"The Korean Paradox: Domestic Political Divide and Foreign Policy in South Korea"** – Giulia Milani

<https://www.routledge.com/The-Korean-Paradox/Milani/p/book/9781032092294>

South Korea – UNCSW Engagement

South Korea has been an active participant in the United Nations Commission on the Status of Women (UNCSW), contributing to global discussions on gender equality and women's empowerment. The country has engaged in various sessions of the Commission, presenting national reports, participating in side events, and collaborating with UN Women and other international partners to address women's rights issues both domestically and globally.

Table: South Korea – UNCSW Engagement

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR Country Page – Korea	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/republic-korea	Human rights record and UN interactions.
UPR – Republic of Korea Reports	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/kr-index	Peer-reviewed human rights evaluation.
National Human Rights Commission of Korea	https://www.humanrights.go.kr	Tracks enforcement and reports violations.
Amnesty International Reports – Korea	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/asia-and-the-pacific/east-asia/south-korea/	Civil rights, freedom of expression.
Human Rights Watch – Korea	https://www.hrw.org/asia/south-korea	LGBTQ+, protest rights, freedom of press.
Freedom House – Korea Score	https://freedomhouse.org/country/south-korea/freedom-world/2024	Quantitative measure of

		freedoms.
UNGA Human Rights Speeches – Korea	https://gadebate.un.org	Official human rights discourse.
UN Treaty Body – Korea	https://tbinternet.ohchr.org	Treaties signed and monitored.
Special Rapporteur Visits	https://www.ohchr.org/en/special-procedures-human-rights-council	Reports on field visits to Korea.
Korean Bar Association Human Rights	https://www.koreanbar.or.kr	Legal professionals on human rights cases.
UN Web TV – Korea at UNHRC	https://media.un.org/en/search?term=south+korea+human+rights	Videos of relevant speeches.
UNHRC Interactive Dialogue Reports	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/hrc	Debate participation by Korea.
Brookings Korea Human Rights Analysis	https://www.brookings.edu	Scholarly insight on legal and political reforms.
Asia Pacific Forum – NHRIs	https://www.asiapacificforum.net	Inter-governmental human rights accountability.
East Asia Forum – Human Rights in Korea	https://www.eastasiaforum.org/category/countries/south-korea/	Regional perspective on rights debates.

Title	Link	Relevance to UNCSW Agendas
Republic of Korea - Country Fact Sheet	UN Women Data Hub	Provides statistical data on gender equality indicators in South Korea, aiding UNCSW's monitoring efforts.

UN Women Knowledge and Partnerships Centre in the Republic of Korea	<u>UN Women Asia-Pacific</u>	Focuses on capacity development and knowledge exchange, supporting UNCSW's objectives.
Overview: UN Women Centre of Excellence for Gender Equality	<u>UN Women Asia-Pacific</u>	The Centre is dedicated to advancing gender equality, aligning with UNCSW's mission.
Republic of Korea - the United Nations	<u>UN Women</u>	Details South Korea's commitments and contributions to the UNCSW.
The Fight Over Gender Equality in South Korea	<u>Carnegie Endowment</u>	Analyzes the challenges and progress in gender equality, relevant to UNCSW's focus.
CSW67 (2023)	<u>UN Women</u>	Highlights South Korea's participation and contributions during the 67th session of the UNCSW.
CSW68 (2024)	<u>UN Women</u>	Details South Korea's involvement in the 68th session of the UNCSW.
Ministry of Gender Equality and Family - Official Website	<u>MOGEF</u>	Provides information on South Korea's national gender equality policies and initiatives.
South Korea-2020 Commitments - National Action Plans	<u>PeaceWomen</u>	Outlines South Korea's commitments to gender equality and women's empowerment.
World Report 2024: South Korea	<u>Human Rights Watch</u>	Provides an overview of human rights issues, including gender equality, in South Korea.
UN Women's Commitment to the Action Coalition on Gender-Based Violence	<u>UN Women</u>	Details South Korea's contributions to global efforts on gender-based violence.
UNCSW68 DPRK - Jubilee Campaign USA	<u>Jubilee Campaign</u>	Discusses the situation of women in North Korea, relevant to regional gender equality efforts.
UN Women's Highlights 2023–2024	<u>UN Women</u>	Summarizes key achievements and initiatives, including those involving South Korea.
Empowering Change: Uniting Voices for Gender Equality at UN	<u>Instagram</u>	Showcases South Korea's participation in global gender equality events.

UNCSW67 Official Documents	UN Women	Provides access to official documents from the 67th session of the UNCSW.
UNCSW68 Official Documents	UN Women	Access to official documents from the 68th session of the UNCSW.
UN Women's Commitment to the Action Coalition on Gender-Based Violence	UN Women	Details South Korea's contributions to global efforts on gender-based violence.
Republic of Korea - Country Fact Sheet	UN Women Data Hub	Provides statistical data on gender equality indicators in South Korea.
UN Women Knowledge and Partnerships Centre in the Republic of Korea	UN Women Asia-Pacific	Focuses on capacity development and knowledge exchange.

Unique Aspects of South Korea's Engagement with UNCSW:

- **Active Participation in UNCSW Sessions:** South Korea has been a regular participant in UNCSW sessions, actively engaging in conversations about global gender equality issues.
- **Commitment to Gender-Based Violence Initiatives:** The country has committed to providing financial assistance to meet the needs of women and girls affected by conflict, in line with UN Women's initiatives focused on gender-sensitive peacebuilding.
- **Advancement of Gender Equality Policies:** South Korea, through its Ministry of Gender Equality and Family, has rolled out various policies designed to promote gender equality and empower women.
- **Support for Women's Economic Empowerment:** South Korea is rolling out initiatives aimed at boosting women's involvement in the workforce and providing support for women entrepreneurs, which plays a significant role in driving economic empowerment.
- **Focus on Gender-Based Violence Prevention:** The country has actively engaged in worldwide initiatives aimed at preventing and tackling gender-based violence, including its involvement in the Generation Equality Action Coalitions.